

SOMYA SATSANGI, *52*

Business consultant, ***Delhi***

Dream fulfilled

Travelled 5,000 km by road across the northeast, visiting 16 places, with her twin girls

How Covid changed me

"I realised that you do not need much to enjoy life—just experiences that stay with you forever"

routine during the lockdown offered him a chance to pursue two passions. In September 2020, he bought a plot of land in Sanjegaon near Nashik to plant vines, a dream he had cherished for years after visiting vineyards in France, Germany and elsewhere in Europe. "I always dreamt of it, but never had the time earlier," he says. As Covid restrictions were relaxed, he also brought out his golfing clubs to hone his skills at a game he had begun to learn in 2018. "With no work-related travel, I was motivated to utilise that extra time to pursue things I enjoy. It's a fulfilling experience to learn new things from the basics," he says. While he continues to clock long hours at the consulting firm he works with, Kulkarni begins his day at dawn and plays golf for two hours every morning—and has even reached the level of an amateur handicap.

For Delhi-based Somya Satsangi, 52, who gave up a full-time corporate career for business consultancy, travel became both an opportunity to commune with nature and to bond with her twin girls, Naina and Tara, after the many months of being cooped up in the Covid lockdown. She travelled 5,000 km by road last year, across the Northeast, visiting 16 places in all. "I realised you do not need much to enjoy life," she says, "just experiences that can stay with you forever."

> **"PEOPLE ARE CONSCIOUS THAT THE TIME TO DO THINGS IS NOW—THERE IS NO POINT IN SAVING FOR A RAINY DAY AND DENYING YOURSELF THE PLEASURE OF THE PRESENT"**
>
> **GAURAV AGARWAL,** *Life coach, Pune*

In Navi Mumbai, flamingoes, herons and seagulls gave wing to Amit Chopra's days. Birds he had never noticed near his home in Seawoods now suddenly came alive. He spends hours with his camera these days, capturing images of birds in flight. "It's important to feel rejuvenated. That's how it all began," says Chopra, 56, MD of Thermo Fisher Scientific for India and South Asia. His home is ideally located for his hobby. The surrounding coastal areas have mangroves and wetlands that host several species of native and migratory birds. Chopra invested in good gear and learnt photo techniques online, as well as through a support group. Merlin, an app developed by Cornell University, helps him identify the birds he clicks. "YouTube was my biggest teacher," he says. Shooting birds takes patience, and he now gives it that. "When you are able to distance